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(AI-Generated Session Notes)

AI Workflows to Research Anything, Better

Date & time: Oct. 14, 11:40 AM-12:15 PM EST
Track: Applied AI



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- LinkedIn

Session Description

Every marketer is a researcher: analyzing buyers, tracking competitors, understanding audiences, and uncovering the stories that resonate. The same AI capabilities reshaping marketing are quietly transforming the work behind them: Deep research tools, data analysis at scale, and a new generation of agentic AI are making research dramatically faster, smarter, and cheaper than it's ever been.

In this session, Taylor Radey, Director of Research at SmarterX, will walk through research workflows every modern marketer relies on — buyer research, competitive intelligence, audience and customer insights, and content development — and show how each is being reimagined with AI. Radey will share her full playbook of tools, prompts, systems, and processes, so you can take proven frameworks and make them your own.

The workflows you'll leave with:

- Buyer research that turns sparse public information into a defensible, useful profile in a fraction of the time.
- Competitive intelligence that replaces one-off analysis with continuous monitoring you actually have time to maintain.
- Audience and customer insights for synthesizing what your market is saying across every channel.
- Content research for finding the framings, hooks, and points of view that actually break through.

If you're ready to unlock better intel and insights, this session is for you.

Key Quote

> *"Trust is the quiet byproduct of having actually done the legwork, and when AI does the work, you get that polished output, but without that innate trust."* **- Taylor Radey**

Session Summary

Taylor Radey, Director of Research at SmarterX and an instructor for AI Academy by SmarterX, argued that every marketer is a researcher. Whether building a buyer persona, a competitive

analysis, or a piece of content, she said, the work shares a common shape, yet teams tend to treat each project separately and end up applying AI to bits and pieces of the process rather than rethinking the process as a whole.

Her proof point was SmarterX's State of AI for Business report, built on a survey of more than 2,100 professionals that yielded over 100,000 data points. After roughly an hour of data cleanup, she handed the labeled CSV to Claude inside a project loaded with brand guidelines and past reports, and had a full first draft by noon on Monday, compressing what typically takes weeks into a single morning.

Radey then laid out a repeatable four-stage process, built on a clearly scoped question: gather (ask more questions, because deep research tools have made research cheap), analyze (treat everything as data, from survey spreadsheets and CRM exports to call transcripts and open-ended responses), distill (combine sources before concluding and use AI as a thought partner rather than a retriever), and verify (trace every claim back to a credible source and check the math).

Verification was the theme she said she has thought about most. When AI does the legwork, the output looks polished but lacks the trust that comes from doing the work yourself, so she checks sources, asks for source grounding on important claims, and built a skill that flags which numbers need checking and writes the prompts for the minimum pivot tables needed to confirm them.

She closed by showing how the same workflow can run on autopilot, using a scheduled task and a skill in ChatGPT to deliver a weekly competitive intelligence brief every Friday, and challenged attendees to pick one question they have been putting off and spend an afternoon working through the process.

Key Takeaways

- **Scope the question first.** Move from vague prompts like "research this competitor" to a specific question using the formula "I'm researching X in order to understand or answer Y."
- **Stop rationing research.** Deep research tools change the economics of which questions are worth asking, so break big questions into smaller assignments, write prompts like research briefs, and run them across multiple models.
- **Treat everything as data.** Clean and label inputs so AI understands the context, then ask what you can calculate, compare, or segment, including in transcripts, interviews, and open-ended survey responses.
- **Combine before you conclude.** Bring all sources into one place, push AI to surface what is surprising, contradictory, or overlooked, and reshape findings into tables, visuals, or mind maps to spot patterns.
- **Trace every claim.** Check source credibility, require source grounding for important claims, and verify numbers efficiently, because speed only matters if you trust the answer.
- **Automate the handoffs.** Connectors, skills, scheduled tasks, and agents can run the same gather-analyze-verify workflow continuously, such as a weekly competitive intelligence brief.